
INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE

UNIT 4 LITERARY REPRESENTATIONS

Tuesday 18 June 2019 07:00 GMT Time allowed: 2 hours 30 minutes

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an Oxford AQA Exams 12-page answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book. The **Examining Body** for this paper is AQA.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work that you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **all** questions. There is **one** question in Section A and **one** question in Section B.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.

Section A: Prose

0	1
---	---

Read carefully the following passage. It is taken from CJ Sansom's novel *Winter in Madrid*, first published in 2006.

At the point of this extract, in February 1937, Barbara Clare waits to hear news of her boyfriend Bernie Piper, who is a soldier in the Spanish Civil War fighting in the British Battalion of the International Brigades. They are opposed to the Fascist forces of Franco which are threatening to capture Madrid.

Write an analysis of this extract, in which you focus on the significance of the representation of the impact of war on civilians.

[25 marks]

For two weeks after he left she had no news. She went to work and stumbled through the day, but when she returned to the flat and he wasn't there the silence seemed to echo as though he was dead already.

In the first week of February news came of a Fascist offensive to the south of Madrid. They were aiming to sweep round and cut the capital off completely, but they were held at the Jarama river. The radio and newspapers spoke of a heroic defence, Franco's advance checked before it had really begun. The International Brigades were prominent in the fighting. They said there were heavy casualties.

Every morning before work Barbara went to army headquarters in the Puerta del Sol. At first the staff were suspicious, but when she came a second day and a third they were kind to her. She had let herself go, she was losing weight and there were dark rings under her eyes, her pain visible to all.

The headquarters was chaotic, uniformed clerks running around clutching papers, telephones ringing everywhere. Barbara wondered whether some of those phone lines connected with the front, if there might be a connection between one of those buzzing rings and the place where Bernie was now. She did that all the time now, made connections in her head: the same sun shines down on us both, the same moon, I hold a book that he held, put a fork in my mouth that he put in his . . .

There was serious fighting in the second and third week of February, but still she had no news. She had had no letters, either, but they told her communications were difficult. Towards the end of February the fighting lessened, turned into another stalemate. Barbara hoped news might start coming through now.

She heard on the last day of February, a cold early spring day. She had come to HQ before work as usual and this time a uniformed clerk asked her to wait in a side room. She knew at once it was bad news. She sat in a shabby little office with a desk and typewriter and a portrait of Stalin on the wall. She thought, irrelevantly, how does he keep that big moustache in order?

The door opened and a man in captain's uniform came in. There was a paper in his hand and his face was sombre. Barbara felt a chill run through her, as though she had fallen through ice into dark water. She didn't get up to shake hands, just sat there.

'Miss Clare. Good afternoon. I hear you have come here many times.'

'Yes. For news.' She gulped. 'He's dead isn't he?'

The officer raised a hand. 'We do not know for sure. Not for sure. But he is on the list of those missing believed killed. The British Battalion was in heavy fighting on the thirteenth.'

‘Missing believed killed,’ she said flatly. ‘I know what that means. You just haven’t found a body.’

He didn’t answer, just inclined his head.

‘They fought magnificently. They held back the Fascist advance on their own for two days.’ He paused. ‘Many could not be identified.’

Barbara felt herself fall from the chair. As she collapsed to the floor she started weeping uncontrollably, pushing herself into the floorboards because under them was the earth, the earth where Bernie was buried now.

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Poetry

0	2
---	---

Read carefully the following poem by the Caribbean poet Derek Walcott, published in 2010, and answer the question below.

'A London Afternoon' finds the poet in London, but he cannot recognise the England he was taught about at school, the England which was the seat of the British Empire. Today's England seems very different from the version described in the sonnets of Sir Thomas Wyatt and the Earl of Surrey.

Write an analysis of this poem, in which you focus on the significance of the representation of race and culture.

[25 marks]

A London Afternoon

Afternoon. Durrants. Either the lift (elevator),
with shudder and rattle, its parenthesis,
or the brown bar with its glum, punctual waiter
and his whatever accent; biscuits and cheeses
with hot, broadening tea with blessing friends.
Summer London outside, guests, porter, taxis,
the consoling clichés you have come back for,
welcomed, but not absorbed, the little ecstasies
of recognition of home, almost, in the polite roar
of traffic towards dusk; here are all the props,
the elaborate breakfasts, kippers, sporting prints,
the ornate lettering on the smallest shops,
the morning papers and the sense of permanence
under every phrase. This is where it must start:
hereditary in each boy (or chap),
the stain that spreads invisibly from the heart,
like the red of Empire in a schoolroom's map.

What have these narrow streets, begrimed with age
and greasy with tradition, their knobbly names,
their pizza joints, their betting shops, that black garage,
the ping and rattle of mesmerizing games
on slot machines, to do with that England on each page
of my fifth-form anthology, now that my mind's
an ageing sea remembering its lines,
the scent and symmetry of Wyatt, Surrey?
Spring grass and roiling clouds dapple a county
with lines like a rutted road stuck in the memory
of a skylark's unheard song, a bounty
pungent as clover, the creak of a country cart
in Constable or John Clare. Words clear the page
like a burst of sparrows over a hedge
"but though from court to cottage he depart,
his saint is sure of his unspotted heart"
and the scent of petrol. Why do these lines
lie like barred sunlight on the lawn to cage
the strutting dove? My passing image in the shops, the signs.

Glossary

Durrants	an upmarket London hotel
Kippers	a type of smoked fish
Slot machines	machines operated by inserting a coin in a slot
Wyatt and Surrey	two Elizabethan poets
Constable	a nineteenth-century landscape painter
John Clare	a late eighteenth-century pastoral poet

END OF QUESTIONS

There are no questions printed on this page

There are no questions printed on this page

There are no questions printed on this page

Copyright information

For confidentiality purposes, acknowledgements of third party copyright material will be published in a separate booklet rather than including them on the examination paper or support materials. This booklet is published after each examination series and is available for free download from www.oxfordaqaexams.org.uk after the live examination series.

Permission to reproduce all copyright material has been applied for. In some cases, efforts to contact copyright-holders may have been unsuccessful and Oxford International AQA Examinations will be happy to rectify any omissions of acknowledgements. If you have any queries please contact the Copyright Team, AQA, Stag Hill House, Guildford, GU2 7XJ.

Copyright © 2019 Oxford International AQA Examinations and its licensors. All rights reserved.



1 9 6 X L T O 4 A